



except the usual niggles with contrast and colour which plagued us throughout DisplayMate and occasionally during our game and movie tests. At Rs 8,500 it's similarly priced to the X173W from Acer, so we recommend you give this one a wide berth.

LG L177 WSB-PF

Value-oriented all-rounder

A neat-looking LCD with solid build quality. This was one



of the only monitors to who DisplayMate was really kind throughout the tests, although we did notice issues with contrast and some minor issues with point shape and visibility in the geometry tests. While gaming, this monitor performs decently, except when a good contrast ratio is called for. This was one of the only 17-inch monitors on which *Oblivion* looked glorious. If you're looking for an all rounder in this size category you've just found it—at just Rs 8,500.

NEC 1770NX-BK

The weakest link

Sporting the same kind of build quality that we saw on the larger 19-inch NEC monitors, the 1770NX immediately ran into issues with contrast in DisplayMate—nearly half of our grey cards were indistinguishable from black. In the colour tests, for some weird reason, the 16-shade intensity ramp had serious issues with the four brightest intensities in the colour green, and with the three brightest intensities in the colours red and blue where the shades looked the same—a shame for this monitor. In games the contrast ratio was noticeable although the colour issue was only apparent with games. At



Rs 18,900 nobody is going to lose any sleep over whether to purchase this monitor or not, so we'll leave it at that.

Samsung 732NW

We'd like to imagine a lot more

A compact and cute monitor, the 732NW is built well. It's a mediocre performer as DisplayMate revealed in the colour and contrast tests,



Buying Guide			
Needs	Suggestions	We Say	Price Range
A basic LCD monitor for an Internet/home PC	LG L177 WSB-PF	Decent colours and contrast, a good entry level monitor	Rs 8,500
A high-end LCD for gaming and full 1080p HD content	LG L246Wp	Based on an 8-bit P-MVA panel, this 1920x1200 pixel resolution sporting panel is just what the doctor ordered. With connects galore and a sterling build quality, a stand that lets you swivel in and out of portrait mode, and even adjust the height, this is a steal	Rs 28,000
High-end multimedia and gaming on the cheap	Dell SP 2208 WFP	With an integrated 2.0 megapixel webcam, HDMI port and a great panel with stunning contrast and colours this monitor is a steal at the price it commands	Rs 15,386
A non glossy panel, something that offers a good dose of performance and is well priced	Samsung 2253LW	This monitor even outperforms the Dell, and is better for a matte panel that cuts down on reflection. Very good for gaming and movies, the price is a on the high side	Rs 17,500
A professional grade monitor with spot on colour and geometry rendition	NEC MultiSync 1990 SX	An 8 bit S-IPS panel doing duty inside just says it all, excellent colour rendition, perfect for image editing professionals. Very costly, keep fingers crossed for a price drop	Rs 42,000
A decent 19-inch monitor for home usage, with some multimedia performance	Samsung 953 BW / Dell 1908 FP	Both these monitors are different beasts. The Dell is a regular panel while the Samsung is a widescreen. They're both excellent for the price though.	Rs 9,899–10,000

although to its credence the geometry tests were cleared without incident or hiccup. In *F.E.A.R.*, it got the usual criticism we've levelled against most panels—a poor contrast ratio, and lower brightness. At Rs 8,850 it's a little expensive to recommend.

ViewSonic VA1716W

For crying out loud!

ViewSonic's 17-inch offering has a plasticity body, devoid of any of the fancy glossy materials we're used to seeing. We ran into problems at every step of our test—the first stop being



DisplayMate, where the poor contrast became apparent. Also the geometry tests, normally a breeze for most LCDs were a pain here, we had issues with line and point resolution.

Then came the colour tests and (sigh) by this time we nearly gave up—the performance in the shade ramp tests was terrible particularly with the 256 shade ramp, where this monitor is not capable of many variations in intensity of the same colour.

Needless to say it's not very suitable at gaming and movies too. Neither is the text rendition as clear as other

monitors. Performance doesn't come cheap, a known analogy, but its corollary is also true—what you don't pay for, you don't get.

24-inch LCD Monitor
Coming soon...to an affordable price near you

LG 246Wp

A colossus of expletives

When we saw this giant screen we knew we had something special. It's heavy, has a huge stand and allows the screen to swivel for a portrait mode. Portrait mode is never more apparent than on a huge widescreen—where the screen size is larger than an A3 sheet of paper.

The thickness of the outer casing and the amount of heat dissipated by the panel told us that this was either an MVA or a PVA panel.

In fact, this is a P-MVA panel. Calibrating it wasn't easy, since keeping yourself at eye-level with such a large screen is nearly impossible.

In DisplayMate, we saw



strong contrast, and a lot of grey cards were visible with a really black background—a good showing for contrast for this panel. In the colour tests we saw an accurate rendition of red and blue with only a slight issue in the 256 shade ramp test for the colour green.

In our movies test we got to experience the full glory of 1080p, and this monitor handled colour and contrast very well. Only in *F.E.A.R.* did we see a little issue with contrast, but this was only in one or two areas. *Oblivion* looks gorgeous at 1920 x 1200 pixels, and you'll be as mesmerised as we were. With a price tag of Rs 28,000 this monitor may seem expensive, but that's before you consider the quality of the panel inside, and the extra functionality that the stand gives you. It makes for a terrific gaming or multimedia monitor—just make sure your graphics card can handle the large resolutions you want.

Closing Thoughts

Though newer models are being introduced around twice a year, there's hardly any difference in terms of quality—larger screens are getting cheaper, but they're hardly getting better.

Sure, features like HDMI and other connectivity and orientation options have become cheaper, but the biggest factor—quality—essentially remains the sole dominion of costlier panels. So while the common user has a plethora of ever-changing options the discerning buyer is stuck at a crossroad—does he go cheap or does he pay significantly more for something that is noticeably better?

This is a question which manufacturers should be made to answer. ■

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Asus	ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd	022-67668800	Media_india@asus.com	http://in.asus.com
BenQ	Neoteric.esys	1-800-22-0808	sales.enquiryin@BenQ.com	www.benq.co.in
Dell	Dell India Pvt. Ltd	1800-425-4026	dell_enquiries@dell.co.in	www.dell.co.in
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